

Fulton County Hail Warning: What to Inspect on Your Roof

Large hail damage means ice stones - sometimes an inch or more across - striking your shingles hard enough to bruise, crack, or knock granules loose, weakening the roof's protective layer long before you see a leak. That risk is live right now: the National Weather Service warned that thunderstorms over Fulton County may produce damaging winds and large hail this evening, with a 90 percent chance of rain (Source: [NWS Atlanta](#), August 2026). Knowing what to inspect after the storm passes protects both your roof and any future insurance claim.

The short answer: After tonight's hail, inspect for dented or cracked shingles, granule loss in gutters, dinged metal flashing, and interior ceiling stains - then document everything with photos before calling anyone. **Who this affects:** Fulton County homeowners in the storm path, plus adjacent Cobb, DeKalb, and Gwinnett communities with older shingle roofs. **What to do:** Do a ground-level and interior check first, then schedule a professional roof inspection to confirm hidden damage. **Timeline:** Peachtree recommends inspecting within 1-2 days of the storm passing, while damage is fresh and clearly documentable.

Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors uses AI-powered drone inspections to capture hail bruising and wind lift from angles a ground check misses - producing a photo-documented report that strengthens your claim from day one.

What Hail Damage Actually Looks Like on an Atlanta Roof?

Hail damage on asphalt shingles shows up as round bruises, cracked mats, and bare spots where the protective granules have been knocked away. Those granules shield the asphalt from UV rays, so once they're gone, the shingle ages faster and becomes prone to leaks. The NWS forecast specifically called out large hail for Fulton County this evening, which is exactly the size range that dents softer metals and fractures aging shingles (Source: [NWS Atlanta](#), August 2026). Check your gutters and downspout splash zones first - a sudden pile of granule grit is one of the clearest early signs. If you find it, photograph the debris before it washes away.

What Should Fulton County Homeowners Inspect First After Tonight's Storm?

Start from the ground and inside the house, then move to a professional check for the roof itself. Walk the perimeter looking for dented gutters, torn screens, cracked window trim, and split fascia and soffit - collateral hail hits often predict roof damage above. Inside, scan ceilings and the top corners of upstairs rooms for fresh water stains, which spread fast once a shingle's protective layer fails. Check metal roof vents, chimney caps, and flashing for dimpling, since bruised flashing is a frequent entry point for water. Do not climb the roof yourself - wet, hail-battered shingles are slick and unstable.

Which Metro Atlanta Neighborhoods Face the Highest Roof Risk Tonight?

Fulton County sits at the center of tonight's hail and wind threat, but the vulnerability varies by housing stock and terrain across Metro Atlanta. In Buckhead and Sandy Springs, mature tree

canopies mean high winds can drop limbs onto steep-pitched roofs, compounding hail bruising with impact punctures. Older ranch and split-level homes in south Fulton and neighboring DeKalb often carry aging three-tab shingles that crack more easily under large hail than newer architectural shingles. In Roswell and Alpharetta, two-story homes with wide roof planes catch more direct hail, while townhome clusters in Smyrna and Vinings share continuous roofs where one hailstorm can damage multiple units at once. Marietta and East Cobb subdivisions built in the 1980s and 90s frequently have roofs near the end of their service life, so tonight's storm may push a marginal roof past repair. The common thread is age and exposure - the older and flatter the roof plane, the more granule loss and cracking you should expect to find.

As a roofing company serving Fulton, Cobb, DeKalb, and Gwinnett, Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors has completed storm damage assessments across these exact neighborhoods and housing eras.

How Do You Compare Roof Risk by Location and Housing Type?

The table below ties tonight's hail and wind threat to specific housing stock and the action each homeowner should take.

Location	Housing Type	Primary Vulnerability	Homeowner Action
South Fulton	1970s-80s ranch homes	Aging three-tab shingles crack under large hail	Check gutters for granules; schedule inspection
Buckhead / Sandy Springs	Steep-pitch homes under tree canopy	Wind-driven limb impact plus hail bruising	Inspect for punctures and limb strikes
Roswell / Alpharetta	Two-story wide-plane homes	Large flat roof surface catches direct hail	Document interior ceiling stains promptly
Smyrna / Vinings	Townhome clusters	Shared continuous roofs damaged in one hit	Coordinate a joint HOA-level inspection

Marietta / East Cobb	1980s-90s subdivisions	Roofs near end of service life	Assess repair vs. full roof replacement
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How Does a Damaged Roof Turn Into a Denied Insurance Claim?

Insurers can deny hail claims when they attribute damage to pre-existing wear or deferred maintenance rather than the storm. That's why documentation timing matters: cracked flashing, missing granules, or lifted shingles that predate tonight weaken your case, while fresh, dated photos tied to a confirmed NWS hail event support it. Failed flashing around chimneys and vents is a common denial trigger, because a small unaddressed gap can be blamed on age instead of impact. A professional roof inspection distinguishes new hail bruising from old wear and gives the adjuster a clear, defensible record. Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors provides storm damage restoration and insurance claims assistance, documenting each hit so the cause of loss is unmistakable before the adjuster arrives.

What Does Storm Damage Cost - and How Fast Should You Act?

Cost depends on whether you need targeted hail damage roof repair or a full roof replacement, which the inspection determines. A marginal 1980s Marietta roof already near the end of its life may not be worth patching, while a newer Alpharetta roof with isolated bruising may only need shingle repair and flashing work. Confirmed tornado activity earlier this year - including a March 16 EF-0 in Southeast DeKalb County that uprooted trees onto homes and damaged a roof near Snapfinger - shows how quickly a single event can force a replacement decision (Source: [patch.com](https://www.patch.com), August 2026). Acting quickly after tonight's hail protects both your home and your claim, since visible damage often lags the storm by days. Peachtree backs replacements with GAF and CertainTeed manufacturer warranties, so an aging roof can be upgraded to a documented, warrantied system.

Why Does Metro Atlanta's Storm History Make Tonight's Hail Worth Taking Seriously?

Metro Atlanta's recent tornado record proves that even brief, low-end storms produce real structural roof damage. On March 16, 2026, an EF-0 tornado with 75 mph winds tracked 2.77 miles through Southeast DeKalb County near the Snapfinger community, uprooting trees onto homes along Gracehill Road and Oak Run Drive and damaging a roof on Salem Springs Place (Source: [patch.com](https://www.patch.com), August 2026). That damage came from a relatively low-end tornado - tonight's large-hail warning for Fulton County carries its own destructive potential for shingles and flashing. The lesson for homeowners in Decatur, Lithonia, and Stone Mountain, all near that DeKalb track, is that visible damage often lags the storm by days. Inspecting promptly catches problems before the next rain drives water through a compromised roof.

FAQ

How soon after a hailstorm should I get my Fulton County roof inspected?

Inspect within a day or two of the storm passing, while damage is fresh and clearly tied to the dated weather event. The NWS specifically warned of large hail for Fulton County, which gives you a documented cause of loss to reference. Early inspection also catches hidden bruising before the next rain - Fulton's forecast shows repeated rain chances through the week. A prompt professional check produces photos that hold up if you later file a claim.

Can I tell if my roof has hail damage without climbing up there?

Yes - several reliable signs are visible from the ground and inside your home. Look for granule buildup in gutters and downspout splash zones, dented gutters or metal vents, and cracked window trim or siding. Inside, check ceilings and upstairs corners for fresh water stains. Climbing a wet, hail-struck roof is dangerous, so leave the surface inspection to a professional using drone documentation.

What is an AI-powered drone roof inspection and why does it help my claim?

An AI-powered drone inspection uses aerial imaging to capture close-up, high-resolution photos of every roof plane, including hail bruising and lifted shingles a ground check can't see. The result is a photo-documented report that timestamps damage against a confirmed storm date. That record helps an adjuster distinguish new hail impact from old wear, which reduces the chance of a denial. It also keeps you safely off a slick, damaged roof.

Should I file an insurance claim before or after I get repairs done?

File and get the damage documented before any permanent repairs - repairing first can make it harder to prove the storm caused the loss. Take dated photos immediately, then have a professional inspection completed so the adjuster sees the full extent. You can make temporary emergency repairs to prevent further water intrusion, but keep receipts and photos of the pre-repair condition. This order protects your claim and your reimbursement.

My roof is from the 1980s - is it worth repairing or should I replace it?

If your roof dates to the 1980s or early 90s, a large hailstorm often pushes it past the point where repair makes sense. Older three-tab shingles common in Marietta and East Cobb subdivisions crack more easily and have less useful life remaining. An inspection weighs the cost of patching against a full roof replacement and factors in whether isolated damage or widespread granule loss is present. Many aging roofs near end of life qualify for replacement under a storm claim when the damage is properly documented.

Does hail damage to my gutters and siding count in a roof claim?

Yes - dented gutters, cracked siding, and damaged fascia and soffit are collateral evidence that supports a roof claim. Adjusters look at these softer surfaces because visible hail hits on metal and trim confirm the storm's intensity where roof bruising is subtler. Document all of it with dated photos, not just the shingles. Comprehensive documentation of the whole exterior strengthens the case that a single storm caused the loss.

Are DeKalb County homes still at risk after this year's tornadoes?

Yes - DeKalb saw confirmed tornado activity earlier in 2026, including a March 16 EF-0 near the Snapfinger community that damaged a roof and dropped trees onto homes. Areas near that track, like Lithonia and Stone Mountain, remain exposed to Metro Atlanta's ongoing storm activity. Even homes that escaped tornado damage may have accumulated minor wear that a new hailstorm

worsens. A current inspection establishes your roof's baseline condition before the next event.

What roofing materials hold up best against hail in Georgia?

Impact-resistant architectural shingles hold up far better against Georgia hail than older three-tab products, resisting cracking and granule loss. Quality installation matters as much as the material - properly sealed flashing and correct nailing prevent the wind uplift that follows a hailstorm.

Peachtree installs GAF and CertainTeed shingle systems backed by manufacturer warranties, which many older Metro Atlanta roofs lack. Upgrading to an impact-resistant system during a replacement can also reduce future storm vulnerability.

Contact Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors for a free inspection.

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